

Knowledge Organiser (BUILD W6): Plan the Story

Humanities Aut 1 · 2026–27 · Enquiry: How can sequence, evidence and explanation turn facts into a coherent historical story?

Key Word	Definition
Plan	The ordered skeleton of an account
Selection	Choosing which facts serve the enquiry
Point	A claim that answers part of the question
Evidence	The source detail backing a point
Explanation	The bridge showing how evidence proves the point
Link	A joining phrase (because, which meant, as a result) that ties the point back to the enquiry — the L in PEEL
Close	The ending that answers the enquiry

Key Facts

- The same facts can build opposite stories — selection and order decide.
- Every point needs evidence; every evidence needs explanation.
- Next week is the telling: today's plan is the safety rail.
- Middlesbrough 1829: ~40 people. 1901: 90,000+. That's the story's engine.

Arrival Task

1) What makes a judgement 'qualified'?

2) Why plan before writing?

3) What must every claim in history carry?

4) Give one linking phrase from Week 3.

Starter: The Same Facts, Two Stories

Key Question: Railway. Ironstone. Migrants. Bridge. Boom. Closure. Same six facts — one storyteller makes a triumph, another a tragedy. What decides?

We Do 1: We Do: Keep It or Cut It?

Groups:  KEEP (serves the enquiry),  CUT (different story). Sort:  Ironstone found 1850,  Railway link 1825,  Migrant families arrive,  Furnace closes 2015,  Terraces built at speed,  Boro's cup run 2004,  Bridge opens 1911,  Iron wages beat farm pay

We Do 2: We Do: Match the Plan Part → Its Job

Draw lines to match:

 Opening ·  Point ·  Evidence ·  Explanation ·  Link ·  Close

The source detail that backs the claim · Answers the enquiry directly · Carries cause from one part to the next · Shows HOW the evidence proves it · One claim that answers part of it · Scene + the enquiry question

Scaffolding – Standard

PEEL Grid Headers

Point (my claim) | **Evidence** (my source detail) | **Explanation** (how it proves it) | **Link** (back to the question)

Link bank — the L in PEEL

because · which meant · as a result · combined with

Reference Zone — keep this beside your work

The story spine — five parts

 **OPENING** — the scene and the question →  **SET-UP** (what it was like before) → 
TURNING POINT (what changed it) →  **LEGACY** (what it left behind) →  **CLOSE** — answer the enquiry.

Each middle part is one PEEL unit

Letter	Its job	Worked example
 POINT	One claim answering part of the enquiry	“Migration made the growth possible.”
 EVIDENCE	The source detail that backs it	“The census lists Irish, Welsh and Scottish households in their thousands.”
 EXPLANATION	HOW the evidence proves the point	“Without those hands, ironstone stays in the hills.”
 LINK	Carries cause into the next part	“which meant the town had to build houses fast...”

 **The explanation is NOT a repeat of the evidence.** It is the bridge between evidence and point. That bridge is where the thinking lives.

Connective dock — grab one, do not invent one

-  **Order:** first · next · later · eventually
-  **Evidence:** for example · the census shows · a photo from ____ shows
-  **Cause:** because · which meant · combined with · as a result

 **WHERE DOES THIS FACT GO? USE THE TRAFFIC LIGHT.**

 **GREEN — SET-UP:** did it happen BEFORE the main change?

 **YELLOW — TURNING POINT:** is it the thing that actually changed it?

 **RED — LEGACY:** did it happen AFTERWARDS, as a result?

 **IT IS A GOOD FACT. WHY WOULD I CUT IT?**

Because a plan is not everything you know — it is everything that answers THIS enquiry.

Test it: *does this fact help answer the question at the top?* No → cut it. A cut fact is not a wasted fact; it is waiting for its own story.



Words I might need: spine · opening · sequence · close · point · evidence · explanation
· link · enquiry

Plan Grid

Enquiry: How did Middlesbrough grow so fast?

Opening:

Unit 1 — P / E / E:

Unit 2 — P / E / E:

Unit 3 — P / E / E:

Close:

Exit Ticket – Standard

1) What decides which facts you keep?

2) What is the explanation's job in a PEEL unit?

3) Write one link phrase you'll use next week.

Lundy Loop — this lesson

Space → Voice → Audience → Influence. The adult’s first job is Space: regulate before you educate.

Space	Planning Corner is open — plan on paper, cards, voice-note or drawing; the format is your choice.
Voice	Tell us your opening line — the class echoes back what question they think your story answers.
Audience	Next week these stories are TOLD — to the class, on tape, or one-to-one. You choose the audience now.
Influence	Class vote: should Week 7's telling allow props and pictures? Your ruling stands.

Closing the loop: out loud, as a class, is enough here. Any inclusion counts — a nod, a word, a pointed finger. If a pupil wants theirs written down, an adult scribes it in *their* words. Pass is always allowed.

Plan the Story — Feedback Sheet

Keep with your book / folder.

Pupil name:	Date:
WWW (What Went Well): 	
EBI (Even Better If): 	
Level worked at: Supported / Standard / Stretch	Evidence filed: Yes / Not yet
Authorship — what I chose or decided myself: 	
Support given — prepared / scribed / modelled / hand-over-hand: 	
Pupil response — my next step: 	